Be careful when seasoning this hearty soup, as the bacon means that little, if any, extra salt will be needed. Try this soup with olive oil croûtons.

split pea and bacon soup

SERVES 6 **PREP** 30 MINS **COOK** 1 HR 10 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

9oz (250g) dried split green peas, rinsed and drained
1½ quarts (1½ liters) water
4–5 slices thick-cut bacon
¼ celeriac, peeled and diced
1 large carrot, diced
1 small leek, diced
1 medium floury potato, peeled and diced
1 tsp dried marjoram
1 tbsp butter
1 onion, diced
freshly ground black pepper
3–4 tsp chopped chives, to garnish

1 Put the peas in a large saucepan with the water and bring to a boil. Add the bacon, cover, and cook for about 40 minutes over medium heat. Add the celeriac, carrot, leek, and potato, and stir in the marjoram. Bring to a boil again, cover, and cook for another 20 minutes.

2 Melt the butter in a separate pan, and add the onion. Brown slightly, stirring continuously, then set aside.

3 Remove the bacon from the soup, chop, and return it to the soup together with the cooked onion. Season with pepper. Sprinkle with chopped chives to serve.